LUMORA

Sprint Report

Game Flow & Story Design

Project progress summary • Concept and experience design

Sprint focus
Define Lumora’s core story premise and player experience flow, including how the game moves from a shared introduction into a personalized, dynamically assembled journey.

Project overview

Lumora is a cinematic, lightweight 2.5D wellbeing game inspired by CBT principles. The player meets Lumi, a kind lantern companion, in a foggy grassy dimension. Through exploration, playful activities, and optional reflection, Lumi learns what matters to the player and helps shape a personalized journey.

Product framing: Lumora is a wellbeing experience, not a clinical treatment product. It does not diagnose conditions, promise cures, or replace professional care.

Reporting scope: Story premise, player flow, journey-building concept, level experience, and design principles.

1. Game Flow: Core Player Flow

The team’s current experience direction uses a shared introduction for every player. After onboarding, the game builds a personalized journey from the player’s expressed interests, preferences, experiences, and self-reported context. The design is **not a branching narrative tree**; it selects suitable level types and assembles their order.

01	**Start & customize** The player opens Lumora and completes lightweight avatar/profile setup.
02	**Enter the dimension** A transition brings the player into a quiet, unfamiliar, foggy grassy world.
03	**Meet Lumi** The lantern companion introduces itself and establishes a supportive tone.
04	**Learn through play** Shared onboarding introduces movement, exploration, interactions, and mini-game conventions.
05	**Discover the player** Lumi learns through optional conversation, choices, activities, and light reflection.
06	**Build the journey** A lightweight on-device classifier/recommendation step selects level types and sequence.
07	**Preview & download** The game explains the selected content and asks for consent before downloading it.
08	**Play & adapt** The player explores, completes activities, reflects, and continues as relevant memories evolve.

Pacing note: Earlier concept exploration used short sessions (approximately 10–15 minutes). Session length and pacing rules remain provisional and will be refined through playtesting.

2. Story Premise & Emotional Arc

The player is transported to a mist-covered grassy dimension—an inviting but unfamiliar place. There, they encounter Lumi, a small, calm, kind lantern mascot whose light symbolizes finding a way forward. Lumi is not presented as an expert with all the answers; it is a companion who explores alongside the player and learns how the player sees their world.

The introduction is shared: every player meets Lumi, discovers the setting, and learns the basic interaction language. Lumi gradually gets to know the player through moments embedded in exploration and mini-games instead of relying only on a long questionnaire.

The intended emotional progression is from unfamiliarity, to trust and curiosity, to agency and a sense of personal direction. The environment and activities support this progression through gentle discovery, play, and reflection.

Lumi’s role

• Begin as a gentle guide and fellow explorer.
• Learn which interests and activities engage the player.
• Refer to relevant, player-approved memories without overstating what is known.
• Encourage agency and choice; avoid shaming, pressure, diagnosis, or certainty about the player’s inner state.

3. Dynamic Journey Building

After the common introduction, a lightweight on-device model/classifier can help organize the player's journey. Its purpose is to recommend content categories and a sequence—not to diagnose the player or make clinical judgments.

Personalization inputs

- Interests and themes the player voluntarily shares.
- Activity preferences and engagement patterns.
- Player-stated life situations or goals, when provided.
- Self-reported feelings or reflections, treated as contextual and changeable.
- Feedback about activities or coping approaches the player found comfortable, unhelpful, or worth revisiting.

Journey assembly process

1. Collect relevant information during the introduction.
2. Explain the purpose of personalization in player-friendly language.
3. Use local classification/recommendation to select appropriate level types and their order.
4. Present a preview and request permission before downloading selected content.
5. Let the player start, skip, pause, or revisit suitable activities.
6. Use player feedback and later interactions to refine future recommendations.

Content structure

The authored experience is planned as modular content. The journey builder selects and orders modules to create a personalized route. This differs from conventional branching, where the story follows a fixed decision tree with pre-authored branches. The exact content taxonomy and recommendation rules remain under design.

4. Standard Level Experience

Explore: Move through a calm 2.5D environment, notice details, and discover interactive objects or locations.

Interact with Lumi: Use brief, contextual dialogue. Conversation is companion-like and optional.

Play: Complete mini-games with clear objectives, curiosity, or skill-practice elements.

Reflect: Offer a short, non-judgmental reflection opportunity; allow the player to skip or decline.

Recognize a moment: Use a visual, narrative, or environmental beat to acknowledge progress without grading the player's emotional state.

Carry forward: Save relevant preferences, reflections, and activity feedback to support continuity.

The same broad pattern can be reused across different themes and level types while varying the environment, mechanics, and reflective activity.

5. Memory, Privacy & Content Delivery

The current design direction prioritizes keeping personal conversation history and journey memories primarily on the player's device. Server-side processing should be purpose-limited and use only the relevant context needed for a feature, rather than transmitting the full personal memory store.

Current design principles

• Minimize personal data collection and server retention.
• Make memory and personalization understandable to the player.
• Provide controls to review, reset, or opt out of personalization where feasible.
• Ask for consent before downloading selected journey content; do not download the full content library by default.
• Communicate what is processed locally versus remotely.

These points represent design intentions. Detailed controls, data schemas, and implementation are not represented as completed.

6. Wellbeing & Safety Design Principles

Lumora's CBT-inspired approach is intended to support self-awareness and practice of helpful coping skills in a game context. The experience remains non-clinical.

• Avoid diagnosis, clinical scoring, treatment claims, and guaranteed outcomes.
• Keep reflection optional and avoid intrusive questioning.
• Do not position Lumi as a therapist or encourage emotional dependence.
• Define and validate handling for distress or crisis disclosures, including appropriate India-based support resources, with qualified review before release.
• Seek CBT-informed review of prompts, mini-games, dialogue, and escalation behavior.
• Complete privacy and age-appropriateness review before deployment.

7. Current Design Status & Next Steps

Defined in this sprint report

• Shared onboarding and first-meeting premise with Lumi.
• High-level player flow from introduction to personalized gameplay.
• Dynamic journey assembly concept based on selecting and ordering modular content.
• Reusable level experience pattern.
• Initial privacy, download-consent, and wellbeing design principles.

Next design activities

• Define the content/level taxonomy and metadata needed for recommendations.
• Map player discovery moments to suitable activities and consent points.
• Prototype a sample journey and test its clarity and pacing.
• Detail the journey-builder inputs, outputs, and fallback behavior.
• Review wellbeing prompts and safety flows with qualified reviewers.
• Validate the experience through internal playtesting and mentor feedback.

8. Summary

Lumora is a gentle 2.5D exploration and mini-game experience where the player meets Lumi in a foggy dimension, shares what matters at their own pace, and receives a consent-based, dynamically assembled journey of play and reflection.

Document status: Sprint report draft. Scope reflects the current concept direction; content definitions, progression rules, safety requirements, and technical implementation remain subject to iteration.